15 STEPS TO CREATING A RISK-BASED CAPA PROCESS

The purpose of this infographic is to help med device companies define and implement a process for corrective and preventive actions (CAPA) that they can use to:

- **Assess and respond to customer feedback**
- **Investigate sources of internal error**
- **Create, implement, and review action plans to improve processes**

15 STEPS TO CREATING A RISK-BASED CAPA PROCESS

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
INQUIRY AND ASSESSMENT				PRE-INVESTIGATION		INVESTIGATION			PLANNING AND EXECUTION		REVIEW AND VERIFICATION			

PHASE 1 - CAPA ASSESSMENT & PRE-INVESTIGATION

1 CREATE CAPA REQUEST AND SUBMIT FOR REVIEW

- CAPA Inputs: NCMRs, Complaints, Internal/ External Audits, Clinicals, Validation
- CAPA Sources: Man, Machine, Material, Method, Environment

CAPA investigations start with a simple request - outline the possible CAPA, its probable sources, and where the feedback/information came from.

INPUTS TO THE CAPA PROCESS

CAPA is the heart of the Quality Management System (QMS) and indicates how effective the QMS is.

2 THE APPROPRIATE RESOURCES SHOULD REVIEW THE REQUEST

Conducted by a quality manager or quality review board (QRB), the CAPA request is reviewed to determine whether an investigation should take place.

Good	Quality Manager reviews CAPA requests.
Better	QRB reviews CAPA requests.
Best	QRB meets weekly/biweekly to review CAPA requests and other open quality issues.

3 ACCEPT OR REJECT THE CAPA REQUEST

Rejected?	Document the reasoning and rationale in case the issue resurfaces.
Accepted?	Move forward with the CAPA process.

4 THE REQUEST IS FORMALLY INITIATED AS A CAPA

Formalize the new CAPA investigation by assigning it a unique identification number. This helps with tracking and referencing the CAPA throughout the investigation.

PRE-INVESTIGATION

5 FINALIZE YOUR CAPA SOURCES

- Identify parties, processes, procedures, and departments that may be associated with the CAPA.
- Be thorough - this is a formal investigation!
- Inform the selection of your cross-functional team - who needs to be involved in the investigation?

6 DETERMINE A CAPA CROSS-FUNCTIONAL TEAM

Assign a team of investigators to understand the CAPA, conduct a complete investigation and create an action plan to resolve the issue.

INVESTIGATION

7 IDENTIFY ANY IMMEDIATE ACTIONS OR CORRECTIONS REQUIRED

Quarantine any nonconforming products or materials. Initiate a recall for any nonconforming products no longer under your control.

8 INVESTIGATE AND CAPTURE FINDINGS

Cross-functional team conducts thorough investigation of the CAPA. The level of effort, formality, and documentation should match the level of risk.

9 DETERMINE A ROOT CAUSE

Use the right analytical tools to accurately determine the root causes of the CAPA. An accurate analysis leads to an effective action plan.

- Cause/Effect Analysis
- Fishbone/Ishikawa Diagram
- 5 WHYs Analysis

ISHIKAWA (FISHBONE) DIAGRAM: CASE AND EFFECT ANALYSIS

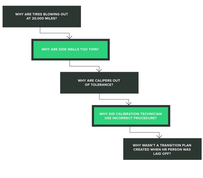
PLANNING AND EXECUTION

10 DEVELOP AN ACTION PLAN

Define and document action steps for correcting the issue and preventing it from happening again.

5 WHY ANALYSIS

Not just 5 questions beginning in "WHY," but each question must lead to the next.



11 COMPLETE THE ACTION PLAN

Assign roles and responsibilities, then execute the action steps in the plan to achieve the desired outcome.

- Update Procedures
- Redesign a Process
- Add an Inspection Step
- Implement Additional Training for Key Staff
- Switch Suppliers
- Modify Manufacturing/Storage Environment
- Change a Policy

REVIEW AND VERIFICATION

12 REVIEW CAPA FOR COMPLETENESS

The quality manager or QRB conducts a review, ensuring that the CAPA process was completed as described and all action steps were implemented.

13 APPROVE CAPA ACTIONS

The quality manager or QRB certifies that the CAPA process was done correctly.

14 SPECIFY STEPS FOR EFFECTIVENESS VERIFICATION

Establish a set of requirements for proving that the CAPA action plan was effective at correcting the CAPA issue and preventing it from happening again.

15 VERIFY THE EFFECTIVENESS OF THE CAPA

Evaluate whether the verification requirements were met. Establish that the CAPA process was effective and the issue was resolved.